



Note. Image from Microsoft PowerPoint Stock Images.

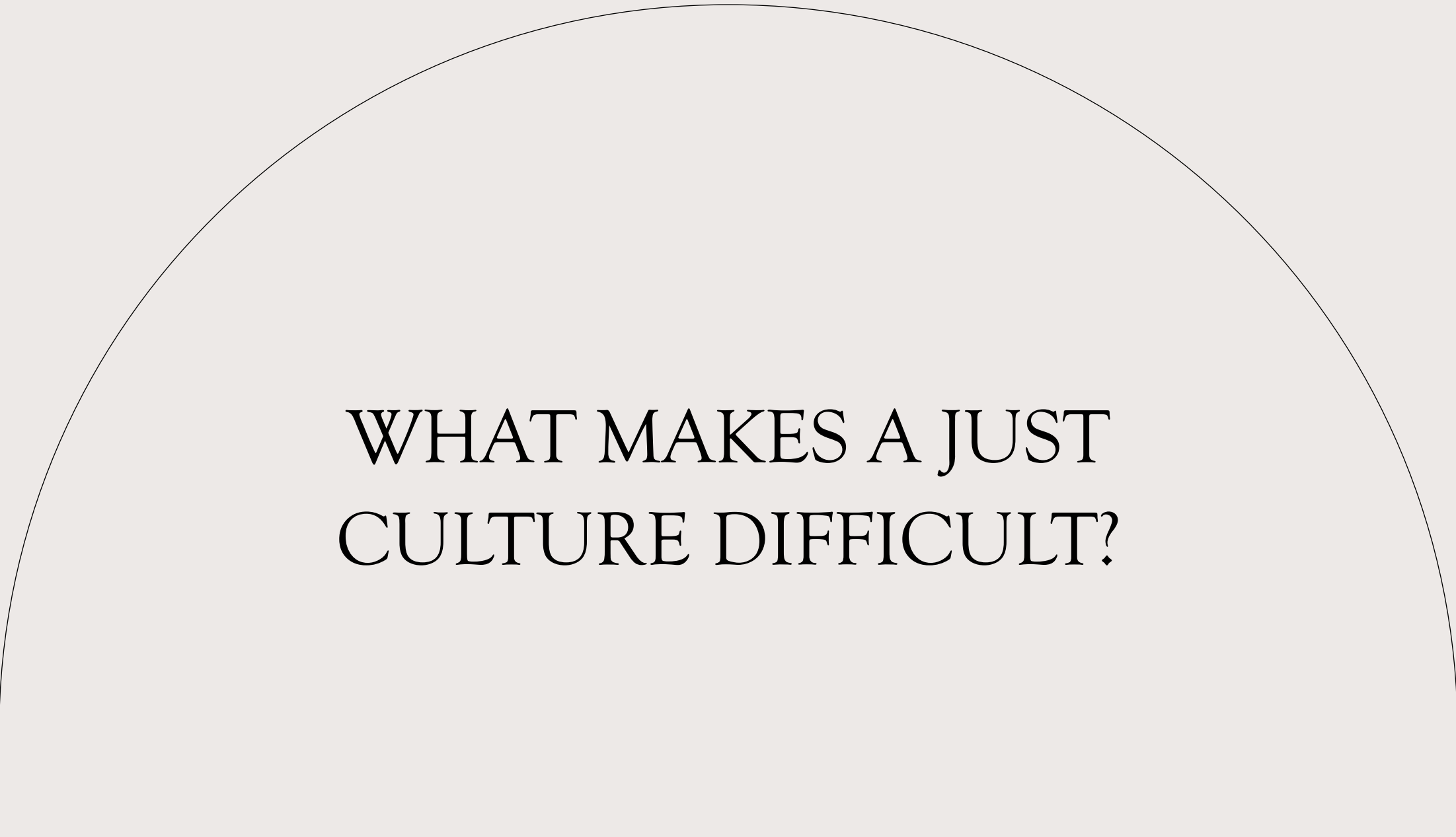
ESTABLISHING A JUST, LEARNING CULTURE

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WHAT IS A JUST CULTURE?

- A just culture is a workplace where employees feel safe reporting mistakes and concerns. It holds people accountable, but first looks at what caused the problem, such as - an honest mistake, risky or reckless behavior, or a problem with the system.
- The goal is to learn from mistakes instead of immediately blaming someone.



WHAT MAKES A JUST CULTURE DIFFICULT?



FEAR OF BLAME OR PUNISHMENT

Employees can be afraid to report mistakes.

- This can be due to:
 - Losing their job
 - Being disciplined
 - Damaging reputation
 - Being blamed by management or coworkers
- While this is understandable, not speaking up makes the organization lose the opportunity to identify the risk and prevent it from happening again.

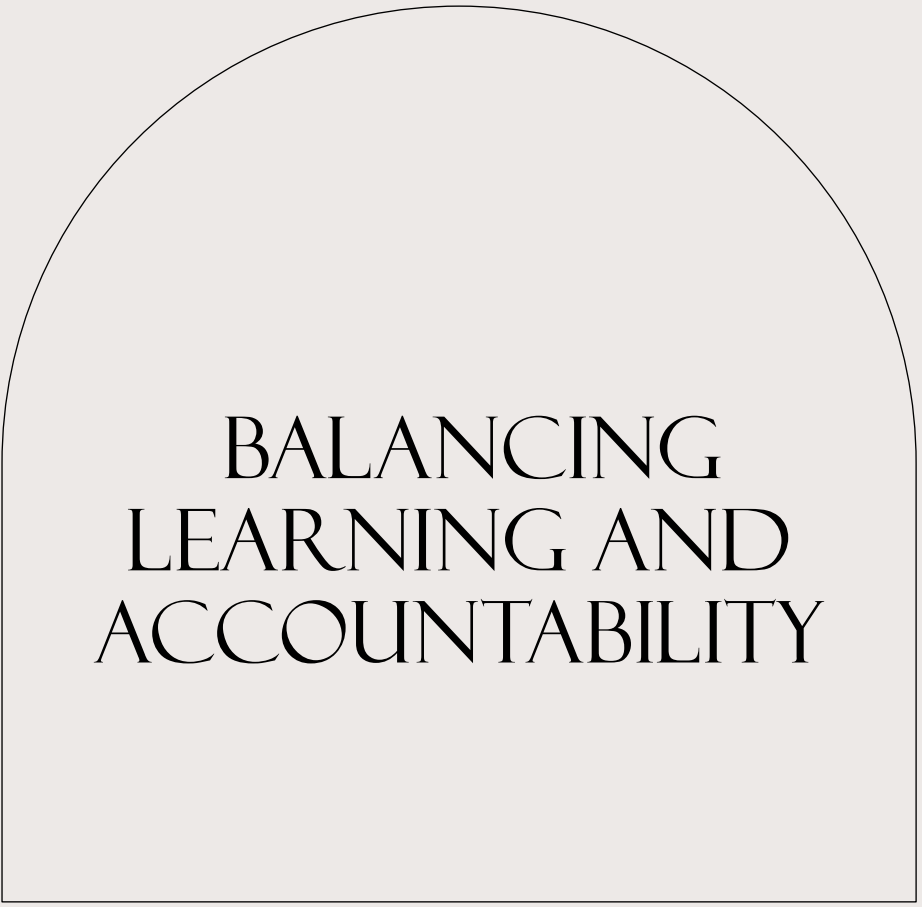


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LACK OF TRUST IN LEADERSHIP

Employees may not believe that management will respond fairly when mistakes happen.

- For example, leaders may say they support open reporting but still punish employees when something goes wrong. This creates confusion and makes the employees less willing to speak up.
- Leadership must respond consistently and show through their actions that reporting concerns is welcomed.

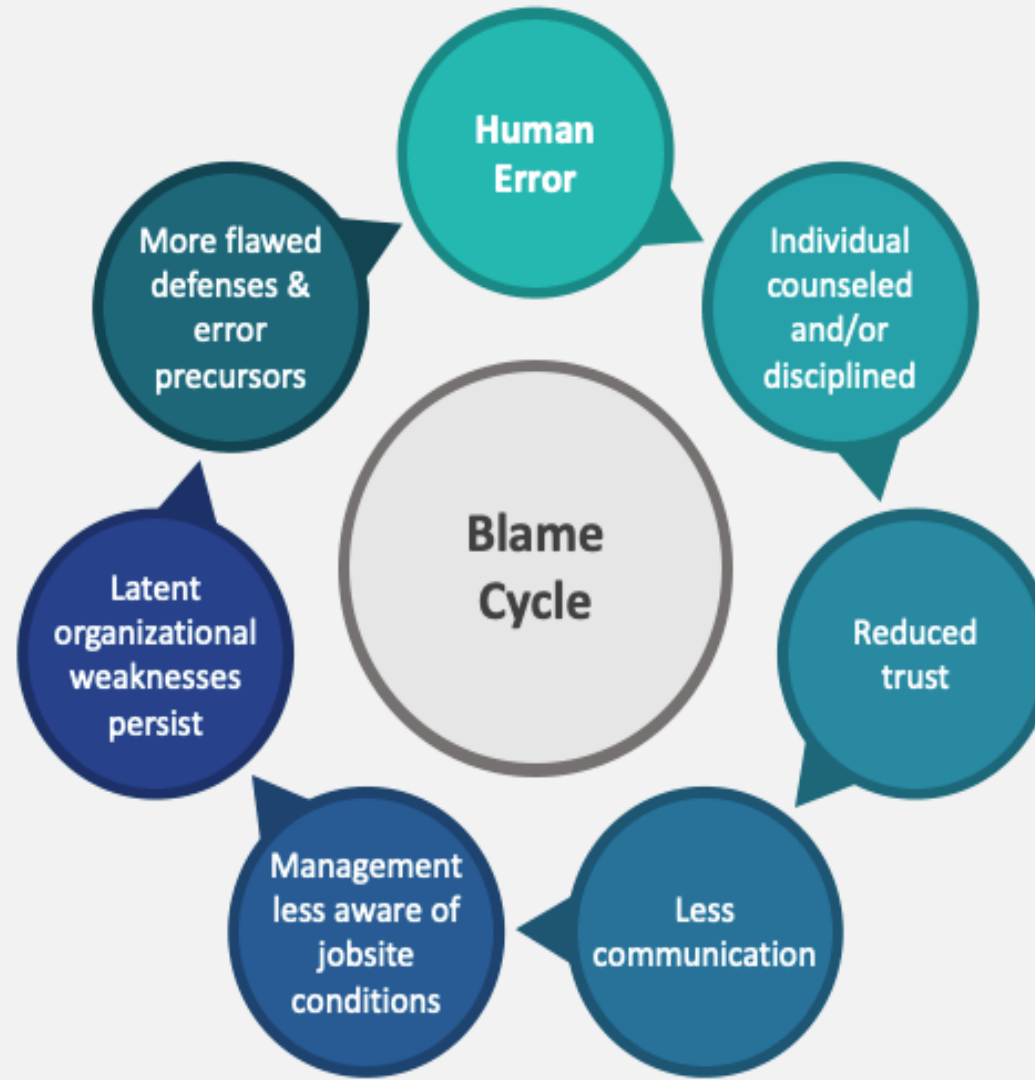


BALANCING LEARNING AND ACCOUNTABILITY

A just culture does not ignore harmful behavior. However, deciding when someone should be held accountable can be difficult .

- Managers must determine whether the employee:
 - Made an honest mistake
 - Took an unnecessary risk
 - Broke a rule on purpose
 - Was working within a poorly designed system
- Different managers can judge similar situations differently due to different beliefs, habits, and values, which can make the process feel unfair.

BLAME CULTURE



Note. Screenshot from Blame Culture, by Collidu (n.d.).

HOW CAN AN ORGANIZATIONS OVERCOME BARRIERS?

- Organizations can support a just culture by:
 - Training all managers and employees
 - Having clear reporting procedures
 - Protecting employees from retaliation
 - Applying rules consistently
 - Investigating system problems, not only individual actions
 - Sharing lessons learned after incidents
 - Holding reckless behavior accountable
- Employees must repeatedly see that leadership responds fairly before trust grows.

CONCLUSION

- The main barriers to implementing a just culture are fear, lack of trust, inconsistent leadership and unclear accountability.
- A just culture cannot be created by only telling employees to report mistakes. Leaders need to create a workplace where employees feel safe speaking up and where reports lead to learning and improvement.
- If implemented well, a just culture can help reduce repeated mistakes and improve safety.

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